

Santiago (Tigo) Ponce de León

Product Design Engineer

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EDUCATION

University of Chicago — B.A. Media Arts & Design and Computer Science

Expected May 2027

Coursework: Human-Computer Interaction, Internet Art & Web Design, Visual Systems

Honors: Spain Foreign Language Acquisition Grant — study in Madrid, Summer 2025

Chicago, IL

EXPERIENCE

Vicino AI — UX Engineer Intern

Jun 2026 - Aug 2026

Bellevue, WA

- Designed product experiences across key workflows for an AI-powered video and marketing platform, turning agentic creative concepts into user-centered interfaces.
- Built front-end UI components in React, bridging Figma designs and production code to accelerate design-to-engineer handoff.
- Shaped and documented the platform's visual language and interaction patterns into a scalable component library used across feature pages.

PantryPal — Product Designer and iOS Developer

Nov 2025 - Present

Chicago, IL

- Designing and building an AI mobile app that turns the ingredients a household already owns into personalized recipes, cutting food waste through inventory reuse.
- Writing the production iOS app in Swift and SwiftUI — designing and coding the same screens — with an App Store release targeted for August 2026.
- Ran user interviews and usability tests between design rounds, and built the system they fed: wireframes through high-fidelity UI, now implemented in SwiftUI.

University of Chicago — UX Researcher

Nov 2025 - Dec 2025

Chicago, IL

- Ran an empirical study of visual and interaction patterns across six AI-generated recipe web apps to measure interface homogenization.
- Deployed prototypes via GitHub Pages and authored the paper on how AI models operationalize a statistical consensus of product design convention.

Next Level Drone Cleaning — Founding Visual Designer

Jul 2025 - Sep 2025

Kortrijk, Belgium

- Designed the complete visual identity for an early-stage drone-tech startup from scratch: brand guidelines, logo suite, and collateral across web, print, and pitch.
- Built the responsive marketing site (nextleveldronecleaning.be) with the founder, plus component libraries that held the team consistent without ongoing design help.

SKILLS

product	User Research, Wireframing, Interaction Design, Design Systems, Usability Testing
engineering	Swift, SwiftUI, React, HTML / CSS / JavaScript, Python, Git, Xcode
design	Figma, Prototyping, Adobe Creative Cloud
languages	Spanish — professional working, English — fluent